



Finding the Right Talent

Attracting the right people to work for you will give your business a competitive edge. Although you may not be able to afford permanent staff, there are other ways of bringing talented people on board.

Identifying your needs

Before looking for potential employees, think carefully about the work that needs to be done. Taking on staff is a big commitment, since recruitment (see pp.124–125), induction, and training all take time and money. Consider whether you could outsource the work to another organization instead (see pp.50–51). For example, many small businesses now outsource their accounting and payroll activities. This avoids the need to employ dedicated staff, allowing you to focus on running the business. Decide whether the work is short term or requires special skills, such as web design or marketing, and whether it could be

undertaken on a freelance basis. A specialist freelancer can provide the expertise you need for the duration of a specific task or project.

Alternatively, if the work is seasonal, or for a limited time period, and requires specific skills or experience, you may wish to employ someone on a fixed-term contract. This approach can provide the help you need without a long-term commitment and its associated costs.

DO'S AND DON'TS

When looking for the right people to fill roles in your business, here are some factors to keep in mind.

Do

- **Try several sources** to find suitable talent
- **Ask friends and family** to refer qualified candidates to you
- **Identify several candidates** in case one turns the role down
- **Keep in touch** with skilled people you may need in the future

Don't

- **Promise** anything that you are unable to deliver
- **Rush into** making a decision; consider all candidates carefully



Catching the talent

Once you have decided upon the type of candidate you need and how you want to employ them (on a freelance, contract, full- or part-time basis) you can select the best way of finding them. Commonly used sources are: